

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Gossip: The Hidden Dagger

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/22220-005-gossip-the-hidden-dagger

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Gossip: The Hidden Dagger

The words of a gossip are like choice morsels; they go down to a man's inmost parts. (Proverbs 18:8)

A perverse man stirs up dissension, and a gossip separates close friends. (Proverbs 16:28)

It was the perfect setup—described in Judges 3. Ehud gets permission to have an audience with Eglon, King of Moab, on a request to present a tribute to him. After the presentation, he whispers that he has a secret message for the king, a word from God. Eglon clears the room, and Ehud pulls a hidden dagger from his clothing and does him in. Inscribed on the handle of the dagger were the letters g-o-s-s-i-p.

The above story is true but for the last sentence. Actually, though, the moniker would have been very appropriate. Ask anyone who's been "done in" by the gossip tongue of another. The weapon comes into the room unseen. It swiftly and lethally assassinates reputations, relationships, and character. It's the "hidden dagger" in human relationships.

Gossip is any talk about another which, when heard, results in undeserved injury. Reporting the truth that Joe Doaks has just robbed your home is not gossip, and the injury caused to Joe Doaks is well deserved. Passing along the unchecked rumor that Mary Doaks is having an affair with her boss is gossip. The injury caused to Mary, her reputation, her marriage, and her aura of trust is both undeserved and deadly—and the gossip is responsible for it.

When Proverbs says that gossip "goes down to a man's inmost parts," it means that it doesn't just bounce harmlessly off the person like the cutting remarks made in jest at the Rotary Club roast. The evil words lodge deeply inside the person like Ehud's dagger, so deeply that Judges says King Eglon's flesh covered it completely. The blade went to his heart.

Principle: Don't take gossip lightly. Far more than harmless chatter, it's a deadly dagger to the heart.

Gossip is equally unsavory because of the friends it keeps. It is the companion of dissension, quarrels, and disloyalty. Its divisive potential is so lethal that it even can separate “close friends” (Proverbs 16:28). Quarrels and arguments are fueled by gossip. “Without wood a fire goes out; without gossip a quarrel dies down” (Proverbs 26:20). Disloyalty is founded on gossip as the evil speaker “betrays a confidence, but a trustworthy man keeps a secret” (Proverbs 11:13).

Principle: Gossip’s companions are worse than urban gangs; Faction, Quarrel and Betrayal are their names.

[from “Wisdom for the Trenches” by Dr. Larry W. Poland]

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → equip.jesonline.com/reviews/share

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping